



A double whammy: Manu Bhaker followed up her bronze in women's 10m air pistol with a second medal as she combined with Sarabjot Singh to win bronze in the 10m air pistol mixed team. RITU RAJ KONWAR

time to get the monkey off her back. It was 604 days later, to be precise, when she won her first ISSF World Cup medal since the Tokyo disaster.

Another significant milestone was

breached three months later when Manu and her former coach Jaspal Rana, under whose tutelage she had bagged 10 senior World Cup medals and a Commonwealth Games gold, decided to bury the hatchet after having a public fallout in 2021.

The results were for all to see a year later when Manu topped the Olympic Selection Trials in both 10m air pistol and 25m sports pistol, thus making it impossible for selectors to ignore her in either category.

The 22-year-old made sure she repaid the faith with generous interest in Paris. On July 27, Manu's dominant show in 10m air pistol qualification saw her become the first Indian woman to make an Olympic shooting final in 20 years. But aware that the job was only half done, Manu slipped out of the range quietly to focus on what was to follow the day after.

In the final, Manu picked up right from where she left. Not even once